Bow Valley College

Course Outline

HCAD1401

Health Care Aide Role & Responsibility
Winter 2026 - Current

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

HCAD1401 Health Care Aide Role & Responsibility

COURSE DESCRIPTION

During this course, you will focus on the role and responsibilities of a health care aide working in a variety of employment settings. The focus of this course is to share information that will result in safe, ethical, and respectful care based on the needs of the client. Care that meets these standards is known as person-centred care. To meet the goal of person-centred care, the health care aide must be familiar with the provincial legislation that guides safe, ethical, and personalized care. In addition, knowledge of how to work as part of the health-care team is essential, as is the ability to follow your employer's policy and procedures and your job description. The HCA is responsible for identifying, managing, and preventing potential environmental hazards in facilities and community-based settings and focusing on the client's safety as well as your own safety in different settings. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	3
HOURS	45
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning

8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Examine the Health Care Aide role, responsibilities, and competencies within Alberta and the Canadian health-care system and the applicable government legislation, standards, and employer policies and procedures that govern the Health Care Aide profession.	2, 4
2	Describe the concepts of person-centered care, holistic health, illness and disability, and the effects of determinants of health on individuals and communities	9
3	Explain the Health Care Aide role when delivering person-centered care (considering the client's needs, rights, preferences, and willingness to participate in care) across acute (including mental health) and continuing care (home care, long-term care, and supportive living) settings.	6, 8
4	Examine the attitudes and behaviours that demonstrate professionalism and accountability of the Health Care Aide's actions and apply health-care ethics within the role of the Health Care Aide.	4, 6
5	Recognize the importance of continuing competence through professional development such as continuing education and digital literacy using feedback and self-reflection to imrove Health Care Aide competencies.	5
6	Examine the Health Care Aide role and responsibilities when applying the person-centered care principles to enhance, advocate, and maintain quality of life of a client in a collaborative team environment.	1, 2
7	Describe the importance of the Health Care Aide role, responsibilities, and skills within the collaborative care team and the care planning process in the health-care environment.	7, 8
8	Describe the environment hazards, infection prevention and control principles, and hazard assessments in the health-care environment.	2, 10
9	Describe the strategies to promote client safety and prevent falls in acute and continuing care (home care, long-term care, and supportive living) settings.	2, 8
10	Demonstrate the principles of infection and prevention and control and safe body mecahnics using evidence-informed practices to promote personal and client safety.	4, 1, 2

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Module 4: Environmental Safety
Week 2	Module 4: Environmental Safety
Week 3	Module 4: Environmental Safety
Week 4	Module 1: Role of the Health Care Aide
Week 5	Module 1: Role of the Health Care Aide
Week 6	Module 2: Legislation
Week 7	Reading Week (dates may vary)
Week 8	Module 3: Functioning Effectively as a Team Member
Week 9	Module 3: Functioning Effectively as a Team Member
Week 10	Module 3: Functioning Effectively as a Team Member/Module 5: Client Safety
Week 11	Module 6: Self-Care and Safety
Week 12	Module 6: Self-Care and Safety
Week 13	Module 5: Client Safety/Module 6: Self-Care and Safety
Week 14	Final Exam

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-10	Final Exam	100%
1-10	Completion of Lab Skills	Pass/Fail

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this course. As well, in courses HCAD1401, HCAD1403, HCAD1404, HCAD1406, and HCAD1407 learners must achieve a "pass" on all lab skills outlined in the Lab Skills Guide.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 1 HCA role and responsibility. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker– Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

OR

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

HCA Lab Kit (Available for purchase at the bookstore)

Bow Valley College Health Care Aide Program Scrub Uniform (Grey/Black) (Available for purchase at the Bookstore)

Latex-free gloves (100 gloves).

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional References:

Alberta Health Care Aide Directory. (2019). *Health care aide directory*. Retrieved from https://www.albertahcadirectory.com/

Alberta Health Services. (2011). *Online training: Health Information Act*. Retrieved from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/page3962.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021, October). *Hazardous medication personal protective equipment (PPE) guide and list*. Retrieved November 9, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/info/hp/pharm/if-hp-pharm-hazardous-medications-ppe-guide.pdf

College and Association of Registered Nurses of Alberta, College of Licensed Practical Nurses of Alberta, & College of Registered Psychiatric Nurses of Alberta. (2010). *Decision-making standards for nurses in the supervision of health care aides*. Retrieved November 9, 2021, from https://www.clpna.com/wp-content/uploads/2013/02/doc_Decision-Making_Standards_in_Supervision_of_Health_Care_Aides_2010.pdf

Alberta Government. (2018, April). *Alberta Health Care Aide Competency Profile*. Retrieved November 9, 2021, from https://open.alberta.ca/publications/9781460137253

Northstar. (n.d.). *Northstar digital literacy assessment*. Retrieved from https://www.digitalliteracyassessment.org/

Service Alberta. (n.d.). *Online training: FOIP*. Retrieved from https://www.servicealberta.ca/foip/training/online-training.cfm/

Wilk, M. (2022). Performing hand hygiene. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Using personal protective equipment. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

World Health Organization. (1986). *The Ottawa charter for health promotion*. Retrieved from https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/ottawa-charter-for-health-promotionhttp://www.who.int/healthpromotion/conferences/previous/ottawa/en/index.html

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan.

Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby

enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.
Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.